

Proposed Solution

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase: 3. Project Design Phase

This document describes the proposed automation, what makes it useful, and the benefits it delivers.

1. Solution Overview

The solution automates the end-to-end ordering of **standard laptops** on ServiceNow. An employee selects a laptop from a catalog item; Flow Designer then handles approval, purchase order or procurement task creation, asset record creation and notifications without manual hand-offs.

2. Solution Features

#	Feature	Description
1	Standard Laptop catalog item	Pre-defined laptop configurations, quantity, cost centre, justification and needed-by date.
2	Automatic approval routing	Manager approval for every request; Finance approval when cost exceeds a configurable threshold.
3	Reminders and escalation	Pending approvals trigger reminders and escalate after the SLA period.
4	Auto PO / procurement task	On approval, a procurement task or PO is created with data mapped from the request.
5	Asset update	When the laptop is received, an asset record is created and linked to the requester.
6	Notifications	Email and portal alerts at submission, approval, rejection, order and delivery.
7	Error handling	Flow failures are logged and the administrator is alerted.

3. Novelty and Uniqueness

- Low-code automation built entirely with Flow Designer, so changes need no scripting.
- Approval rules driven by system properties, so Finance can change thresholds without a developer.
- One flow covers the full lifecycle from request to asset record.

4. Business and Social Impact

Area	Impact
Time	Approval and order processing reduced from days to hours.
Cost	Less manual effort; spend controlled through threshold-based approval.
Accuracy	No re-typing, so fewer errors in PO and asset data.
Experience	Employees get laptops sooner, improving onboarding and productivity.
Compliance	Complete audit trail for internal and external audits.

5. Scalability

The same pattern (catalog item, approval flow, procurement task, asset record) can be reused for monitors, accessories, software licences and other IT infrastructure by adding new catalog items and subflows.